



### HOW TO FILL OUT THIS SHEET:



- Rub out all mistakes completely.
- Print your details clearly in the boxes provided.
- Make sure you fill in only one oval in each column.

### EXAMPLE 1: Debbie Bach

**FIRST NAME**

LAST NAME

DEBBIE

BACH

**EXAMPLE 2:** Chan Ai Beng

FIRST NAME

LAST NAME

|                                    |                         |                                    |                         |                                    |                         |                                    |                         |                                    |                         |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| C                                  | H                       | A                                  | N                       | A                                  | I                       | B                                  | E                       | N                                  | G                       |
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| <input type="radio"/> A            | <input type="radio"/> A | <input checked="" type="radio"/> A | <input type="radio"/> A | <input checked="" type="radio"/> A | <input type="radio"/> A | <input type="radio"/> A            | <input type="radio"/> A | <input type="radio"/> A            | <input type="radio"/> A |
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**EXAMPLE 3:** Jamal bin Abas

FIRST NAME

LAST NAME

The image shows two 6x6 grids. The left grid has the letters J, A, M, A, L in the first row and B, I, N in the second row. The right grid has the letters A, B, A, S in the first row. In both grids, some letters are filled in black, and some are filled in pink. The letters are arranged in a way that suggests a word search or a similar game.

**FIRST NAME** to appear on certificate

[illegible]

**LAST NAME** to appear on certificate

[illegible]

Are you male or female?

☐ Male ☐ Female



Does anyone in your home usually speak a language other than English?

☐ Yes ☐ No

School name: \_\_\_\_\_

Town / suburb: \_\_\_\_\_

Today's date:     /    /          Postcode:           

## DATE OF BIRTH

| Day | Month | Year |
|-----|-------|------|
| 0   | 0     | 0    |
| 1   | 1     | 1    |
| 2   | 2     | 2    |
| 3   | 3     | 3    |
| 4   | 4     | 4    |
| 5   | 5     | 5    |
| 6   | 6     | 6    |
| 7   | 7     | 7    |
| 8   | 8     | 8    |
| 9   | 9     | 9    |

**CLASS**  
(optional)

|  |     |     |
|--|-----|-----|
|  | (A) | (K) |
|  | (B) | (L) |
|  | (C) | (M) |
|  | (D) | (N) |
|  | (E) | (O) |
|  | (F) | (P) |
|  | (G) | (Q) |
|  | (H) | (R) |
|  | (I) | (S) |
|  | (J) | (T) |



## TO ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

### Example:

Choose the word that is closest in meaning to the underlined word.

I want you to give this important matter prompt attention.

- (A) quiet
- (B) careful
- (C) immediate
- (D) deliberate

Immediate is the word closest in meaning to prompt in this sentence, so you would fill in the oval **C**, as shown.

(A) (B) **C** (D)



## START

- |                    |                    |                    |
|--------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| 1 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 16 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 31 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 2 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 17 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 32 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 3 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 18 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 33 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 4 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 19 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 34 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 5 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 20 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 35 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 6 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 21 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 36 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 7 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 22 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 37 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 8 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 23 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 38 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 9 (A) (B) (C) (D)  | 24 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 39 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 10 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 25 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 40 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 11 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 26 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 41 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 12 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 27 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 42 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 13 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 28 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 43 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 14 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 29 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 44 (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 15 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 30 (A) (B) (C) (D) | 45 (A) (B) (C) (D) |





**E**

## 2011 English Answer Keys

**ICAS**  
International Competitions  
and Assessments for Schools

| Question Number | Paper A | Paper B | Paper C | Paper D | Paper E | Paper F | Papers G & H | Papers I & J |
|-----------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------------|--------------|
| 1               | C       | A       | C       | A       | C       | B       | A            | B            |
| 2               | D       | C       | B       | B       | A       | C       | C            | B            |
| 3               | A       | B       | C       | C       | B       | D       | D            | D            |
| 4               | C       | A       | B       | C       | B       | C       | D            | C            |
| 5               | D       | D       | B       | A       | D       | D       | B            | B            |
| 6               | C       | D       | D       | D       | C       | A       | D            | B            |
| 7               | A       | A       | D       | D       | C       | A       | A            | B            |
| 8               | D       | A       | C       | A       | A       | B       | B            | C            |
| 9               | A       | B       | D       | C       | C       | B       | B            | B            |
| 10              | B       | C       | B       | B       | A       | A       | A            | C            |
| 11              | C       | D       | C       | C       | D       | D       | A            | C            |
| 12              | C       | B       | A       | A       | A       | B       | C            | D            |
| 13              | D       | D       | A       | A       | D       | B       | D            | A            |
| 14              | B       | C       | B       | B       | C       | A       | B            | D            |
| 15              | A       | B       | D       | B       | D       | B       | D            | D            |
| 16              | A       | D       | A       | D       | A       | D       | D            | D            |
| 17              | B       | D       | D       | B       | C       | A       | B            | A            |
| 18              | B       | C       | C       | D       | B       | D       | B            | B            |
| 19              | C       | D       | A       | C       | C       | B       | B            | A            |
| 20              | C       | A       | C       | C       | B       | D       | C            | B            |
| 21              | B       | A       | C       | B       | A       | A       | D            | D            |
| 22              | B       | B       | B       | C       | D       | C       | A            | A            |
| 23              | A       | B       | A       | A       | A       | B       | C            | C            |
| 24              | C       | B       | A       | B       | D       | C       | B            | D            |
| 25              | C       | D       | D       | A       | B       | B       | D            | B            |
| 26              | D       | D       | C       | D       | D       | A       | A            | C            |
| 27              | B       | C       | A       | C       | C       | D       | B            | D            |
| 28              | C       | B       | B       | C       | D       | B       | D            | C            |
| 29              | B       | C       | B       | A       | C       | C       | C            | C            |
| 30              | D       | D       | C       | D       | C       | A       | D            | C            |

(Please turn over)





**E**

## 2011 English Answer Keys

**ICAS**  
International Competitions  
and Assessments for Schools

| Question Number | Paper A | Paper B | Paper C | Paper D | Paper E | Paper F | Papers G & H | Papers I & J |
|-----------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|--------------|--------------|
| 31              | A       | B       | A       | A       | A       | D       | C            | B            |
| 32              | D       | A       | B       | D       | C       | A       | C            | D            |
| 33              | A       | A       | A       | C       | A       | A       | A            | A            |
| 34              | A       | D       | D       | D       | D       | A       | B            | B            |
| 35              | B       | C       | C       | A       | D       | C       | D            | A            |
| 36              | B       | A       | A       | B       | A       | B       | C            | D            |
| 37              | B       | C       | D       | C       | D       | C       | C            | C            |
| 38              | D       | C       | C       | C       | B       | D       | C            | A            |
| 39              | D       | B       | A       | B       | B       | C       | B            | C            |
| 40              | C       | B       | A       | C       | A       | D       | D            | C            |
| 41              | D       | D       | C       | B       | A       | C       | C            | D            |
| 42              | B       | B       | B       | D       | A       | C       | A            | A            |
| 43              | A       | D       | C       | D       | D       | A       | A            | D            |
| 44              | D       | D       | D       | A       | A       | B       | A            | B            |
| 45              | C       | A       | B       | D       | D       | D       | C            | A            |
| 46              |         |         | B       | A       | B       | D       | C            | A            |
| 47              |         |         | D       | B       | D       | B       | C            | B            |
| 48              |         |         | C       | D       | B       | D       | D            | D            |
| 49              |         |         | B       | B       | D       | C       | A            | A            |
| 50              |         |         | D       | B       | A       | D       | C            | A            |
| 51              |         |         |         |         | C       | B       | B            | D            |
| 52              |         |         |         |         | C       | C       | D            | C            |
| 53              |         |         |         |         | B       | B       | A            | A            |
| 54              |         |         |         |         | B       | A       | D            | C            |
| 55              |         |         |         |         | C       | B       | A            | C            |
| 56              |         |         |         |         |         |         | D            | B            |
| 57              |         |         |         |         |         |         | A            | A            |
| 58              |         |         |         |         |         |         | C            | B            |
| 59              |         |         |         |         |         |         | B            | D            |
| 60              |         |         |         |         |         |         | B            | A            |

### Contact Details

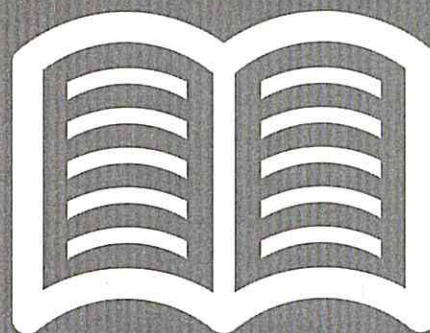
Telephone: (02) 8344 1016  
Email: [info@eaa.unsw.edu.au](mailto:info@eaa.unsw.edu.au)  
Website: [www.eaa.unsw.edu.au](http://www.eaa.unsw.edu.au)





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THE UNIVERSITY OF NEW SOUTH WALES  
SYDNEY • AUSTRALIA

# PAPER B



# 2011 ICAS

International Competitions  
and Assessments for Schools

## ENGLISH

**Educational  
Assessment  
Australia**  
eaa.unsw.edu.au

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

**45 QUESTIONS**

**TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES**

**STUDENT'S NAME:**

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.

Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.



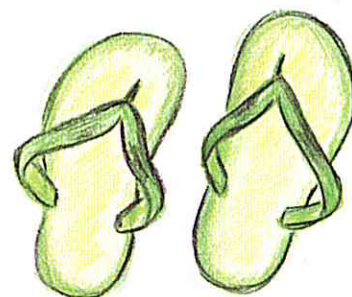
# If the shoe fits ...

## Touching the past

People have always looked for ways to protect their sensitive feet. In ancient times, people made shoes from whatever was handy: bark, large leaves and grass tied on with vines. There is a single sandal from a cave in Oregon (in the USA) made out of sagebrush bark. It is probably the oldest shoe in the world. If you could gently ease your hand inside, you would feel the smooth impression of a big toe. The owner lived over 10 000 years ago. Covered sandals were good for hunting: they were light and flexible, and they probably allowed the owner of the sagebrush shoe to stalk deer silently. But people in hot countries need different types of shoes ...

## Walk like an Egyptian

Egypt is in a hot part of Africa. About three thousand years ago, the ancient Egyptians loved their thongs for the same reasons we do today: they're cheap, you can kick them off easily and they're comfortable on hot days. You've got 250 000 sweat glands on your feet, so keeping them cool is important! Wealthy Egyptians spent a lot of money on their shoes, just like celebrities do today. Tutankhamun was a king—a *Pharaoh*—and when his tomb was discovered in 1923, there were 93 pieces of footwear inside. There were solid gold sandals (could he *really* have walked in them?) and thongs made of wood with pictures of the Pharaoh's enemies painted on their soles so the king could step on them every time he walked anywhere!



Thongs

## Chilly feet

Egypt is just the right climate for thongs but in cold countries what did people wear to protect their feet? The same thing you might be wearing right now: shoes made from leather. At first people simply cut out oval shapes from the skins of dead animals, punched holes around the edges and pulled a lace through to tie them on tightly. Over thousands of years, people invented different ways of doing up shoes—with laces and buckles and buttons. Some changes took longer. Until 180 years ago, you could wear your shoes on either foot—there was no difference between left and right shoes.

1. According to the text, why did people start wearing shoes?
  - (A) to protect their feet
  - (B) to hide their feet from view
  - (C) to help them keep balance
  - (D) to use up left-over materials
2. What does the word 'flexible' mean, as it is used in the text?
  - (A) quiet
  - (B) smooth
  - (C) easy to bend
  - (D) quick to make
3. According to the text, what is one reason ancient Egyptians wore thongs?
  - (A) to show off their feet
  - (B) to keep their feet cool
  - (C) to display their wealth
  - (D) to allow them to walk silently
4. 'Tutankhamun was a king—a *Pharaoh*—'  
The information between the dashes is
  - (A) another word for king.
  - (B) Tutankhamun's last name.
  - (C) a translation of Tutankhamun.
  - (D) an explanation of the word 'tomb'.
5. Why is the word 'really' written in *italics*?
  - (A) to show that it is a question
  - (B) to point out an unusual word
  - (C) to point out an important word
  - (D) to show the writer's amazement
6. Tutankhamun had pictures of his enemies on the bottom of his thongs because he wanted to
  - (A) know how his enemies felt.
  - (B) work out his enemies' plans.
  - (C) remember who his enemies were.
  - (D) have a sense of power over his enemies.
7. To make shoes, ancient people 'cut out oval shapes from the skins of dead animals, punched holes around the edges and pulled a lace through to tie them on tightly'.  
Which picture illustrates this type of shoe?



(A)



(B)



(C)



(D)



# Meg Banana and the Mysterious Umbrella



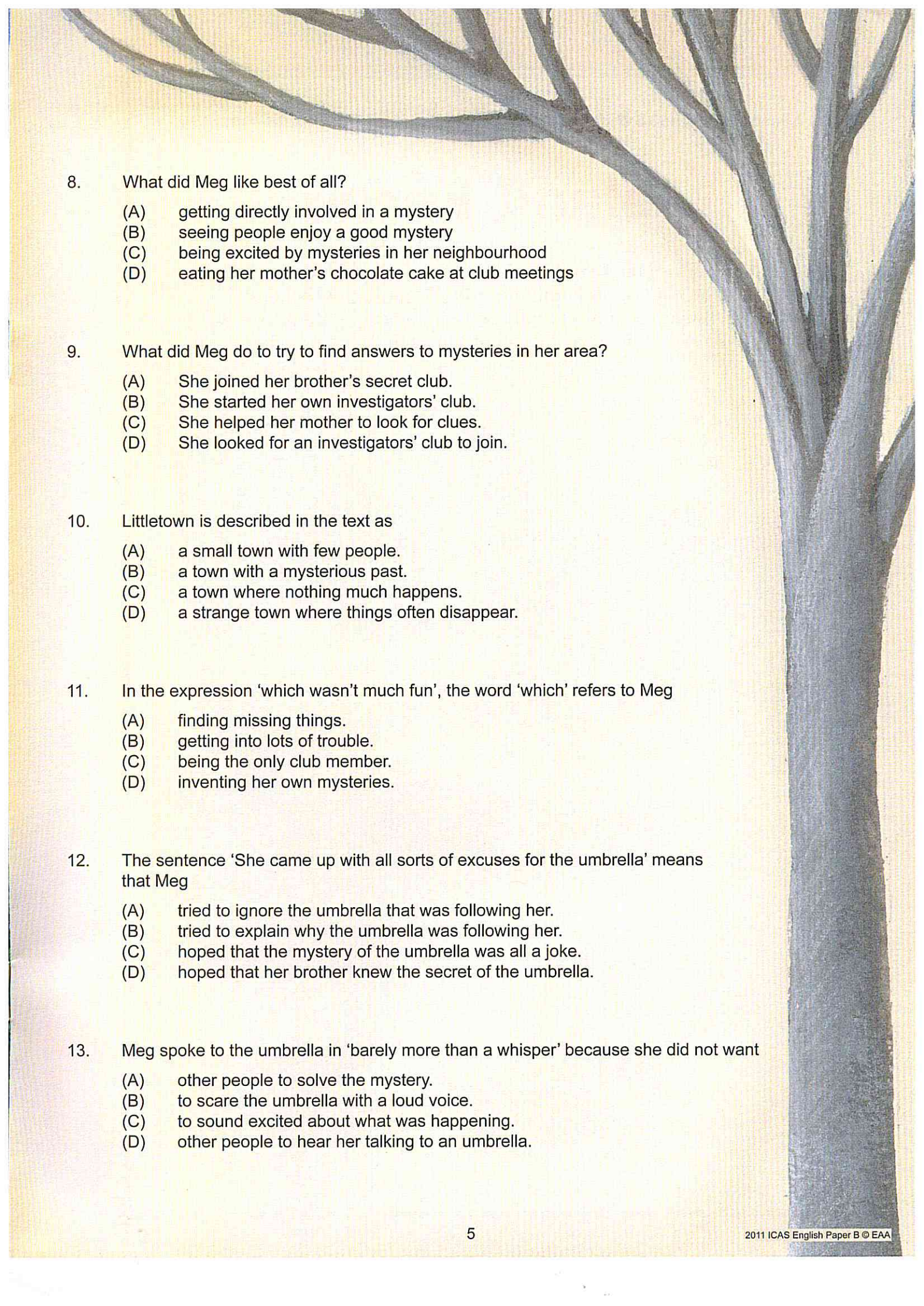
Meg Banana loved a good mystery. She didn't think there was anything more exciting than being at the centre of a truly puzzling or inexplicable event.

To solve all the mysteries in her neighbourhood Meg founded the Littletown Secret Investigators Club. She was President. She was also the only member. Meg didn't count her brother, Brian, because he only came to club meetings to eat the chocolate cake her mother baked each week. He wasn't serious about solving mysteries. But then neither was anyone else. You see, nothing ever happened in Littletown. It was so completely devoid of mystery that Meg often had to invent one herself, which wasn't much fun and got her into lots of trouble. Whenever anything went missing in Littletown, people came to Meg's house first. And they weren't interested in her clues or riddles because they didn't believe there was a mystery to solve.

Which is why they wouldn't believe her now if she told them about the black umbrella that followed her to school by day, then hung in the trees outside her bedroom at night, moaning. And why should they? Meg didn't believe it, at first. She came up with all sorts of excuses for the umbrella, like the wind was blowing it along behind her or that Brian had hung it in the tree as some sort of stupid joke. But after three days, Meg Banana couldn't resist the mystery any longer.

'Are you following me?' she asked, in barely more than a whisper, when she found it hanging in a tree outside the school one afternoon.



- 
8. What did Meg like best of all?
- (A) getting directly involved in a mystery
  - (B) seeing people enjoy a good mystery
  - (C) being excited by mysteries in her neighbourhood
  - (D) eating her mother's chocolate cake at club meetings
9. What did Meg do to try to find answers to mysteries in her area?
- (A) She joined her brother's secret club.
  - (B) She started her own investigators' club.
  - (C) She helped her mother to look for clues.
  - (D) She looked for an investigators' club to join.
10. Littletown is described in the text as
- (A) a small town with few people.
  - (B) a town with a mysterious past.
  - (C) a town where nothing much happens.
  - (D) a strange town where things often disappear.
11. In the expression 'which wasn't much fun', the word 'which' refers to Meg
- (A) finding missing things.
  - (B) getting into lots of trouble.
  - (C) being the only club member.
  - (D) inventing her own mysteries.
12. The sentence 'She came up with all sorts of excuses for the umbrella' means that Meg
- (A) tried to ignore the umbrella that was following her.
  - (B) tried to explain why the umbrella was following her.
  - (C) hoped that the mystery of the umbrella was all a joke.
  - (D) hoped that her brother knew the secret of the umbrella.
13. Meg spoke to the umbrella in 'barely more than a whisper' because she did not want
- (A) other people to solve the mystery.
  - (B) to scare the umbrella with a loud voice.
  - (C) to sound excited about what was happening.
  - (D) other people to hear her talking to an umbrella.



For questions 14 and 15 choose the correct words to complete the paragraph.

## Island Ferry

Today I almost missed the ferry. I had been swimming off the rocks all day when I heard the sound of its horn. The ferry \_\_\_\_ (14) \_\_\_\_ without me! I grabbed my fishing rod, flippers and towel and raced \_\_\_\_ (15) \_\_\_\_ the wharf. When I arrived I was relieved to see the captain waiting for me to climb aboard.

14. (A) leaves  
(B) is leaving  
(C) was leaving  
(D) will leave
15. (A) near  
(B) towards  
(C) before  
(D) against





For question 16 choose the sentence which is PUNCTUATED CORRECTLY.

16. (A) Jan is going to live in Tokyo with her Parents.  
(B) Len told his Mum that he was going to the Zoo.  
(C) Koalas and Kangaroos are very interesting Animals.  
(D) Tourists who come to Australia often visit Canberra.
- 

For question 17 choose the best option.

17. Which of the underlined words is used as an adjective?

Jack followed the instructions for decorating his cake. He needed to dip some

- (A) (B) (C)  
strawberries into melted chocolate.  
(D)



For question 18 choose the best option.

18. Sandra offered her seat on the bus to an elderly man. Sandra's act could be described as  
(A) honest.  
(B) cheerful.  
(C) considerate.  
(D) affectionate.



## *Make a wish*

Carl sat chewing, his glasses balanced on the very tip of his nose. He was concentrating very hard. Cass watched fascinated. One more chew and they would slip off. 'Well,' Carl lifted his head and his glasses slid back into place, 'I don't know if we can do anything more, Cass. If adults can't stop them, what can we do?'

The twins ate in silence, watching the sun slip behind the distant skyline, silhouetting the tall faceless office blocks that poked out of a shifting yellow haze. The din of the city traffic barely reached them. It mingled with the warm shushing sound of the surrounding park.

The Trumper Tree rose above them, majestic and tall, its twisted branches and gnarled trunk swirling in strange patterns. It looked as if it reached into the sky forever.

'I'm going to save a leaf from the Trumper Tree as a memento,' said Cass and she picked up a fallen leaf. 'Here's one for you,' and she handed it to Carl. He was very quiet. The air became heavy and still. The park seemed to be holding its breath. 'Let's make a wish, a wish to make things right,' whispered Cass.

'I don't believe in wishes,' was Carl's reply, but he didn't push the leaf away; he placed it carefully in his pocket.

Around them the valley waited, motionless and silent. Cass shivered. 'I feel strange, eerie. I can almost hear the tree speaking to me.'

'What am I supposed to listen for?'

'Quiet! Can't you hear? There's a sound in the leaves, a sort of stirring, a movement, a rustling.'

'And for your next trick there'll be gnomes in the grass.' Carl was not impressed.

Cass was listening intently. 'It's saying that now is the time, now is special, if we wish now something important will happen.'

'And pigs might fly. Come on Cass, it's time we went home.'

'Please let's try one wish now. Come on Carl, please ...!'

'Oh, all right. Just one, then we must go or Mum and Dad will be late for that meeting.'

'Let's put our arms around the tree and wish hard for something to save it.'



19. What was Carl doing in the first paragraph?
- (A) arguing with his sister
  - (B) hiding from his parents
  - (C) quickly finishing a big meal
  - (D) thinking deeply about a problem
20. The story is set in
- (A) a park.
  - (B) a building.
  - (C) a city street.
  - (D) a sports field.
21. In the second paragraph, the words 'silhouetting the tall faceless office blocks' refer to the effect of the
- (A) sun.                      (B) tree.                      (C) haze.                      (D) skyline.
22. Personification is a type of description that gives human qualities to something which is not human.
- Which quotation uses personification?
- (A) 'The twins ate in silence'
  - (B) 'The park seemed to be holding its breath.'
  - (C) 'There's a sound in the leaves'
  - (D) 'And pigs might fly.'
23. In the third paragraph, why does the writer describe the Trumper Tree as having a 'gnarled trunk swirling in strange patterns'?
- (A) to emphasise how bright the sun is
  - (B) to create a mysterious atmosphere
  - (C) to make a comparison with city buildings
  - (D) to highlight the colour of its leaves and branches
24. Cass gave a leaf to Carl because
- (A) she planned to show him a trick.
  - (B) she wanted him to keep it as a souvenir.
  - (C) she was sharing her love of nature with him.
  - (D) she knew that his hobby was collecting small things.
25. Which quotation shows that Carl would follow Cass and make a wish?
- (A) 'He was very quiet.'
  - (B) 'What am I supposed to listen for?'
  - (C) 'Come on Cass, it's time we went home.'
  - (D) 'Just one, then we must go'
26. Which word best describes Cass?
- (A) logical
  - (B) efficient
  - (C) reckless
  - (D) persistent



Read *Seeing sound* and answer questions 27 to 32.

# Seeing sound

## You will need:

- a plastic garbage bag
- scissors
- a plastic bowl
- a rubber band
- sticky tape
- uncooked rice
- a large spoon
- a stereo or radio with speakers
- loud music with a heavy bass

## What to do:

1. Cut out a piece of plastic from your garbage bag slightly bigger than the rim of the plastic bowl.
2. Stretch the plastic as tightly as you can over the rim of the plastic bowl.
3. Secure the plastic with the rubber band.
4. Sticky tape the edges of the plastic firmly to the bowl.
5. Sprinkle a few grains of the rice on the stretched plastic, using the spoon.
6. Place the bowl next to the stereo speakers and increase the volume of the music that you have selected.

## What's happening?

Every kind of sound is produced by vibration. The source of the sound may be a piano, a television or a barking dog. Whatever it is, some part of it is vibrating while it is producing sound. This makes the air around the source of the sound vibrate too. These vibrations, called 'sound waves', spread out through the air. When they reach your ears, you hear a sound.

Stereo speakers vibrate strongly, especially when the volume is turned up. If you put your hand near the speaker, you can feel its vibrations as a kind of tickling sensation in your fingertips. When the sound waves from the stereo reach the plastic, they cause it to vibrate, and the rice is bounced around as if it were on a trampoline.



27. Which word is closest in meaning to 'slightly', as it is used in the text?

- (A) quite
- (B) even
- (C) just
- (D) almost

28. If steps 2 to 4 are followed exactly, what will the finished result look like?



(A)



(B)



(C)



(D)

29. Why is a piece of plastic a suitable material to use for this experiment?

- (A) It is safe to use.
- (B) It is very cheap.
- (C) It is thin enough to vibrate.
- (D) It stops the rice falling into the bowl.

30. In the section titled 'What's happening?', the word 'This' refers to

- (A) sound.
- (B) the air.
- (C) a television.
- (D) the vibration.

31. Which sequence correctly shows what happens in the investigation?

- (A) music → the plastic vibrates → vibrations in the air → the rice bounces
- (B) music → vibrations in the air → the plastic vibrates → the rice bounces
- (C) music → vibrations in the air → the rice bounces → the plastic vibrates
- (D) music → the plastic vibrates → the rice bounces → vibrations in the air

32. The main purpose of the section titled 'What's happening?' is to

- (A) explain.
- (B) instruct.
- (C) persuade.
- (D) entertain.



# Undercover agent

*Alex is a young spy who has sneaked aboard a plane carrying two men working for Blue, her arch-enemy. The plane is heading into the Amazon jungle.*

Alex looked out the open exit of the small twin-engine plane as it swooped above the dense treetops of the Amazon jungle. The thick canopy of green hurtled beneath them like an enormous ocean, each treetop another wave in a vast flurry that seemed to last forever. They were flying so close Alex was sure that if she ran a hand along the leaves, she could have scooped up the dew that was sprinkled over the jungle like a giant handful of liquid gold. She fixed her eyes on the landscape below and thought to herself, whoever was responsible for making the world was showing off when they made this part.

Suddenly the plane lurched sideways as it struck a pocket of turbulence. Alex's head hit the cold metal wall with a thud as the giant of a man who was in charge of the mission launched another tirade against the pilot.

'Where'd you get your licence from? The back of a cereal box? My three-year-old nephew could fly this plane better than you. I've heard they've trained chimps that could outdo your aviation skills.'

Alex was impressed. She'd been dealing with Blue's thugs for years and 'aviation' was the longest word she'd ever heard from any of them.

The pilot's face remained unchanged. He'd heard all about this guy from the other pilots and had already filled his ears with cottonwool so that none of his cursing could filter through.

The suited tough adjusted his seatbelt tighter around his waist before pulling out a floral handkerchief and wiping his brow. The short, fat guy sitting next to him stared.

'Floral?' he smirked.

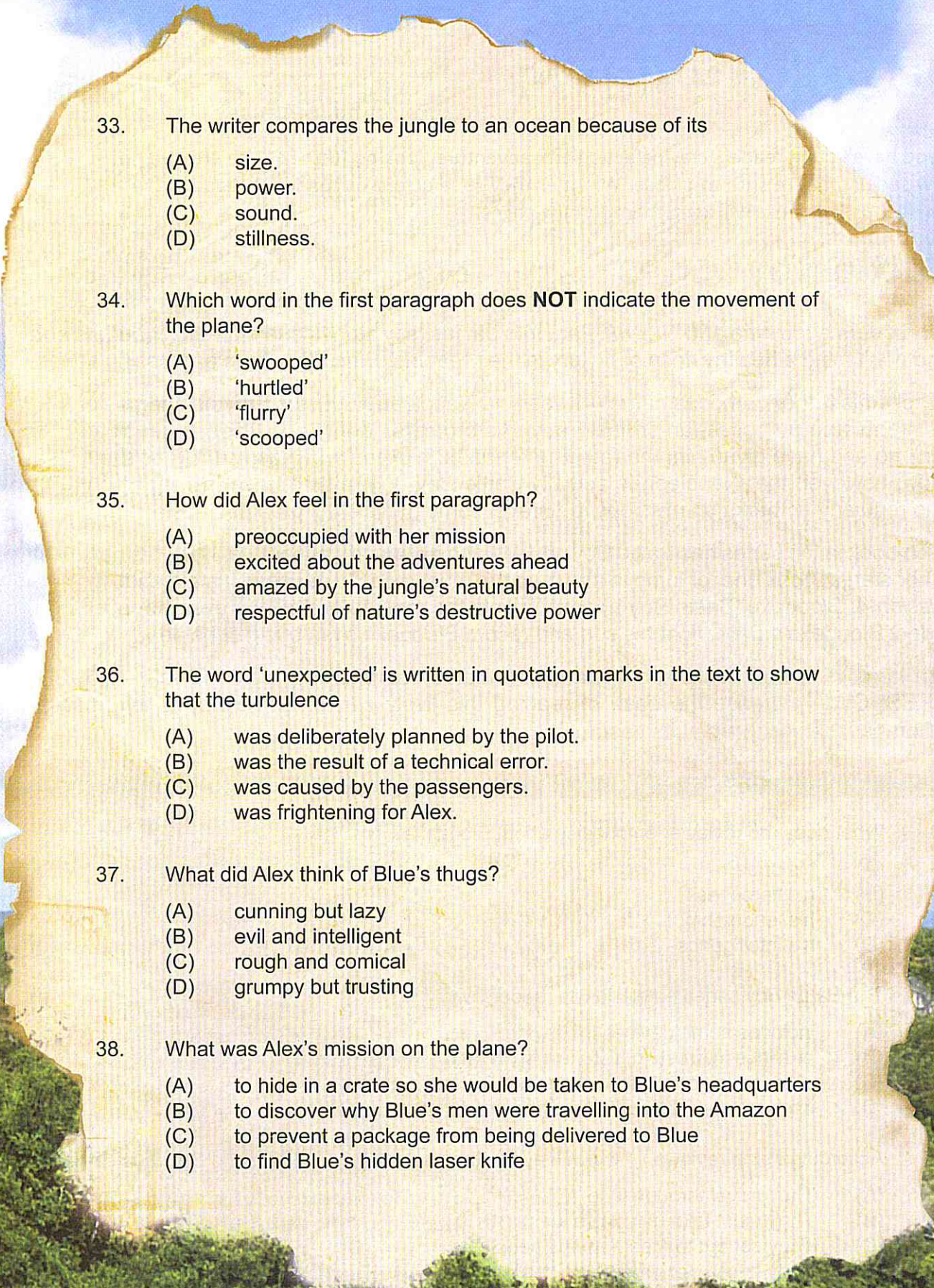
'It was a present from my daughter.' The tough guy said it like a warning, his nerves making him more edgy than usual.

He'd been nervous since the trip began and if Alex's guess was right, the pilot was as skilled as they came and was getting great pleasure out of the occasional and 'unexpected' turbulence the plane was experiencing.

Just then, the short, fat guy buried his head in his lap and filled another sick bag with vomit. Alex thought she saw the faintest of grins on the pilot's face.

She adjusted the miniature parachute on her back and crawled across the metal floor of the cargo plane between wooden crates that were stacked like bowling pins. Taking out her laser knife, she carefully broke the reinforced seals on a few of the crates before she found it. A small humidifier case that, if she was right, was packed with exactly what she was looking for and it was her job to get her hands on it before the case reached Blue.



- 
33. The writer compares the jungle to an ocean because of its
- (A) size.
  - (B) power.
  - (C) sound.
  - (D) stillness.
34. Which word in the first paragraph does **NOT** indicate the movement of the plane?
- (A) 'swooped'
  - (B) 'hurtled'
  - (C) 'flurry'
  - (D) 'scooped'
35. How did Alex feel in the first paragraph?
- (A) preoccupied with her mission
  - (B) excited about the adventures ahead
  - (C) amazed by the jungle's natural beauty
  - (D) respectful of nature's destructive power
36. The word 'unexpected' is written in quotation marks in the text to show that the turbulence
- (A) was deliberately planned by the pilot.
  - (B) was the result of a technical error.
  - (C) was caused by the passengers.
  - (D) was frightening for Alex.
37. What did Alex think of Blue's thugs?
- (A) cunning but lazy
  - (B) evil and intelligent
  - (C) rough and comical
  - (D) grumpy but trusting
38. What was Alex's mission on the plane?
- (A) to hide in a crate so she would be taken to Blue's headquarters
  - (B) to discover why Blue's men were travelling into the Amazon
  - (C) to prevent a package from being delivered to Blue
  - (D) to find Blue's hidden laser knife



# Book reviews

Reviewed by Aleesah Darlison

If you have young readers craving action and adventure, look no further. Here are two hot new series that are sure to please. Whether they're reluctant or confident readers, these fun, fast-paced books will keep them turning pages.

## Battle Boy series

by Charlie Carter with illustrations by Russell Jeffery

For readers aged nine and over who are into battles, spy stories and high-tech gadgets and who don't mind a healthy dose of history in their reading, *Battle Boy* is an engrossing series.

Despite his rather pompous name, 11-year-old Napoleon Augustus Smythe seems, for all intents and purposes, an ordinary boy. His brothers, Monty and Caesar, certainly think so and have given him the rather unfortunate nickname of Nappy. Little do they know, however, that Napoleon is actually Battle Boy 005, a time-travelling superspy who regularly embarks on missions to unravel some of history's greatest mysteries.

Each book in the series has Battle Boy undertaking a separate adventure. Readers can either start at book one, or jump in and read the most recently released instalments. In *Mission 4: Bloodaxe*, Battle Boy not only meets the most feared Viking ever, he must collect Bloodaxe's DNA, fight his son and record Bloodaxe's famous last battle.

The large text, bold fonts and exclamation marks common in graphic novels—YOUCH! YIKES! OW!—increase the ease of reading this lively series. *Battle Boy* is informative, action-packed escapism at its best.



39. What does the reviewer emphasise about Bloodaxe?
- (A) his pride
  - (B) his fierceness
  - (C) his leadership
  - (D) his intelligence
40. The *Battle Boy* series entertains its readers and
- (A) includes some devices for spying.
  - (B) provides interesting historical information.
  - (C) compares modern and ancient spying techniques.
  - (D) informs readers about strategies used in famous battles.
41. According to the reviews, in which way are the characters Napoleon and Decimus similar?
- (A) They travel through time.
  - (B) They must take on a false identity.
  - (C) They set out to meet famous people.
  - (D) They encounter dangerous challenges.



## Gladiator Boy series

by David Grimstone with illustrations by James de la Rue

While *Gladiator Boy* is intended for children aged seven and over, readers should be prepared for some tough themes including slavery, torture, overcoming adversity, and mortal combat. They should also be prepared for awesome characters, terrific battle scenes and heart-thumping tension.

Decimus Rex is a young boy living in ancient Rome. His life changes forever when he is kidnapped by slave-takers to fight in the Arena of Doom in Rome. Will Decimus ever escape? Or is he destined to die in the Arena?

At the heart of this series is a ripping yarn about a slave boy who won't be beaten. Though Decimus' opponents are often bigger, stronger and better armed than he is, they are no match for his bravery, defiance and determination to survive.

Although the books are relatively short at just over 100 pages, they possess a depth in storytelling that sets this series apart. Its no-holds-barred style and realism offer children a unique reading experience in our somewhat sanitised modern world.

42. Which word is closest in meaning to the word 'adversity', as it is used in the text?  
(A) conquest (B) hardship (C) enemies (D) confusion
43. 'Will Decimus ever escape? Or is he destined to die in the Arena?'  
The reviewer's purpose for including these questions is  
(A) to seek factual detail about a character.  
(B) to give hints about the ending of the story.  
(C) to help readers visualise the setting of the fight.  
(D) to create suspense so that readers are attracted to the book.
44. When the reviewer says that the *Gladiator Boy* series has a 'no-holds-barred style', she means that  
(A) the books target children's interests.  
(B) the books are filled with colourful illustrations.  
(C) the books are believable but not over-simplified.  
(D) the books include less pleasant aspects of history.
45. Which quotation from one of the reviews reflects the writer's enthusiasm towards the books she is reviewing?  
(A) 'engrossing series' (B) 'ease of reading'  
(C) 'heart of this series' (D) 'relatively short'



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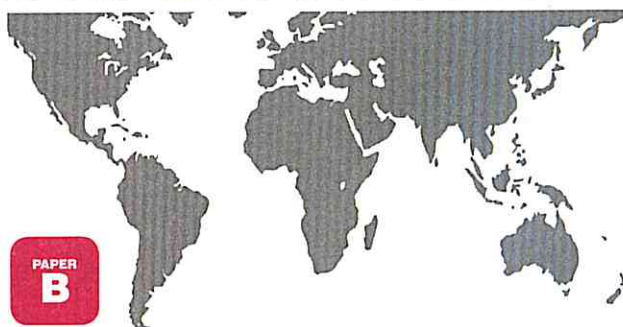


## Sources

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|              |            |
|--------------|------------|
| Australia    | Year 4     |
| Brunei       | Primary 4  |
| Indonesia    | Year 5     |
| Malaysia     | Standard 4 |
| New Zealand  | Year 5     |
| Pacific      | Year 4     |
| Singapore    | Primary 3  |
| South Africa | Grade 4    |



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